

Episode 5: Facing Fir'aun

Based on Qur'an, Surah Ash-Shu'ara (26) : 10-51

Allah commanded, "Go to the wrongdoing people, the people of Fir'aun. Will they not fear Allah?" (26:10-11). Musa answered honestly with his concern: "My Lord, indeed I fear they will deny me, and my breast will tighten and my tongue will not be fluent, so send for Harun" (26:12-13). Allah replied, "No — go both of you with Our signs; indeed We are with you, listening" (26:15).

Before Fir'aun, Musa and Harun declared, "Indeed, we are messengers of the Lord of the worlds — release the Children of Israel with us" (26:16-17). Fir'aun tried to belittle Musa by recalling his childhood in the palace and the killing he had once committed (26:18-19). Musa calmly acknowledged what had happened, then affirmed that Allah had granted him wisdom and sent him as a messenger (26:20-21).

When Fir'aun asked, "And what is the Lord of the worlds?", Musa answered with clarity and majesty: "Lord of the heavens and the earth and everything between them, if you would be certain" (26:23-24). Fir'aun threatened to imprison him, yet Musa steadfastly showed the proofs of his prophethood (26:29-33): his staff becoming a real serpent, his hand shining white for all to see.

The court accused Musa of being a master sorcerer, prompting Fir'aun to gather every skilled magician in the land for a great

contest (26:34-37). When the appointed day came, the sorcerers cast down their ropes and staffs, bewitching the eyes of the onlookers so they appeared to slither like serpents (26:44). But when Musa cast down his own staff, it swallowed up everything they had fabricated (26:45).

The very sorcerers who had been recruited to defeat Musa fell down at once in prostration. "We have believed in the Lord of the worlds, the Lord of Musa and Harun," they declared (26:46-48) — a faith born instantly in the face of undeniable truth, even as Fir'aun raged and threatened them with brutal punishment (26:49).

Reflection: manifest truth can pierce even the hearts of those first recruited to oppose it. Musa's steadfastness under mockery and threat teaches that a message carried with evidence and patience speaks louder than any earthly power.

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